

Big Budget Meeting Instructional Guide

Introduction:

What is the Big Budget Meeting(BBM)?

The BBM as outlined in Addendum E to the Bylaws of Student Government Association(SGA) is a semesterly budget meeting that handles the vast majority of the funding for the next semester. E.g. budgets submitted to and heard at the BBM that is held in Fall 2024, will be in effect during the Spring 2025 semester.

How does the BBM Work?

Firstly, club treasurers put together a budget for the next semester. Guidelines for this budget are outlined in Addendum E – Finance Policy and Budgeting Guidelines for SGA Allocations.

Following this, they submit this itemized and complete budget through Ducklink, and sign up for a time slot to present their budget. **Attendance is mandatory, and organizations that do not show up will have their budget denied.**

Prior to the BBM, budgets are then reviewed by the Budget Committee. The Vice President and Assistant-Vice President of Finance(VPF and AVPF respectively), apply objective cuts that are outlined in Addendum E.

Finally, the BBM is actually held, each treasurer comes before the combined Budget and Student Interests committees and presents their budget. Subjective cuts may be applied by the combined committee.

When and where is the BBM?

This semester, the BBM will be held on the 16th and 17th of November, from 10:00 to 14:15 on each day. The location of the meeting will be communicated to you in advance.

Where can I get more details about the BBM?

The BBM is clearly outlined with detail within Addendum E ([LINK](#)). If a question persists, you can reach out to the AVPF Arthur Serra (aserra1@stevens.edu). Please CC VPF Kevin Pfundstein(kpfundst@stevens.edu) on all BBM communications.

How to Submit:

Pre-Ducklink

Before anything else, the first step to the BBM process is creating an internal budget. Work closely with your fellow E-board members to figure out what your organization wants funding for next semester. Once a fully itemized spreadsheet has been created with your requests you're ready to submit it!

On Ducklink

Once a fully itemized spreadsheet has been created, navigate to the “budget” menu on Ducklink. On the left, right above your current budget there is a drop-down menu which has two options – one for the Fall 2024 budget and one for the Spring 2025 budget. Click on the Spring 2025 Budget.

Now it's time to actually input your line items in Ducklink. Click on the “Create Budget Request” button that's on the left side of the screen. Fill out the first page of the form, don't forget to upload or add a link to your spreadsheet. On the second page you need to enter budget items.

To be very clear – there should be one budget line for one event. If you have multiple categories, use the “Add item” button on the bottom left of the form to create a new budget item. For example, if you were hosting an event with food, prizes and supplies, you'd only use the “Create Budget Request” button once for that event, and have multiple items within it for each category.

Now it's just repeat for each event, and whatever other major categories like GBM food, or promotional items that you might have.

Signing up for a time slot

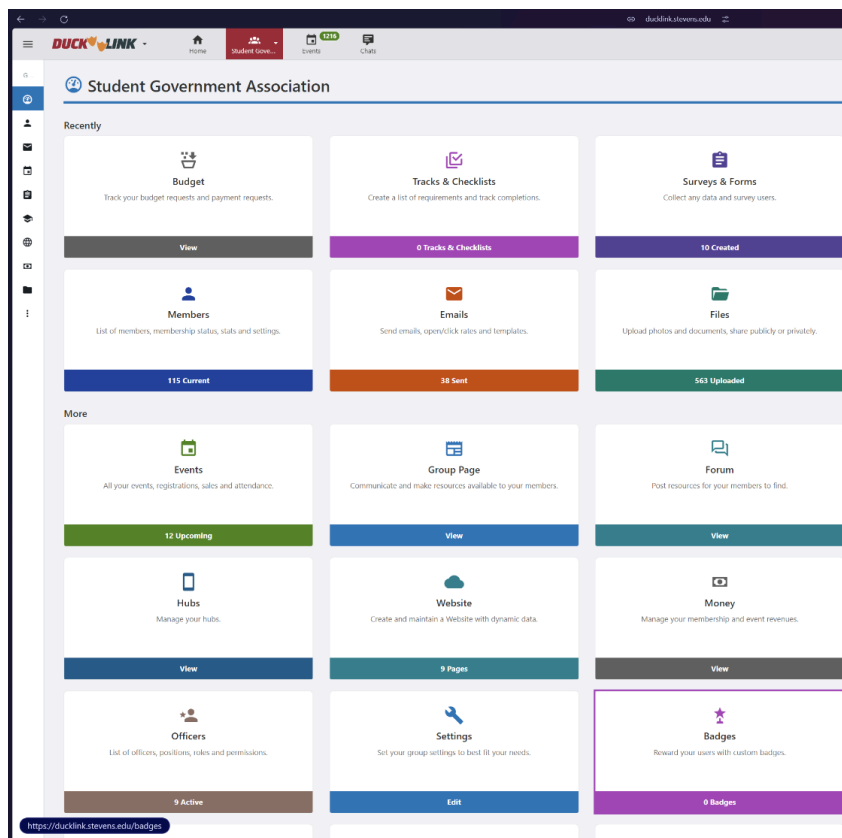
At the end of the “Create Budget Request” form you will automatically be redirected to a “BBM Form.” Most of the questions are straight-forward however, the first question is whether you have signed up for a time slot. The first time you submit a line item hit “no”, and follow the instructions that pop up. Simply add your organization’s name on a google spreadsheet schedule. **Removing or changing someone else’s slot is grounds to have your entire budget denied.**

How to Submit(With Pictures)

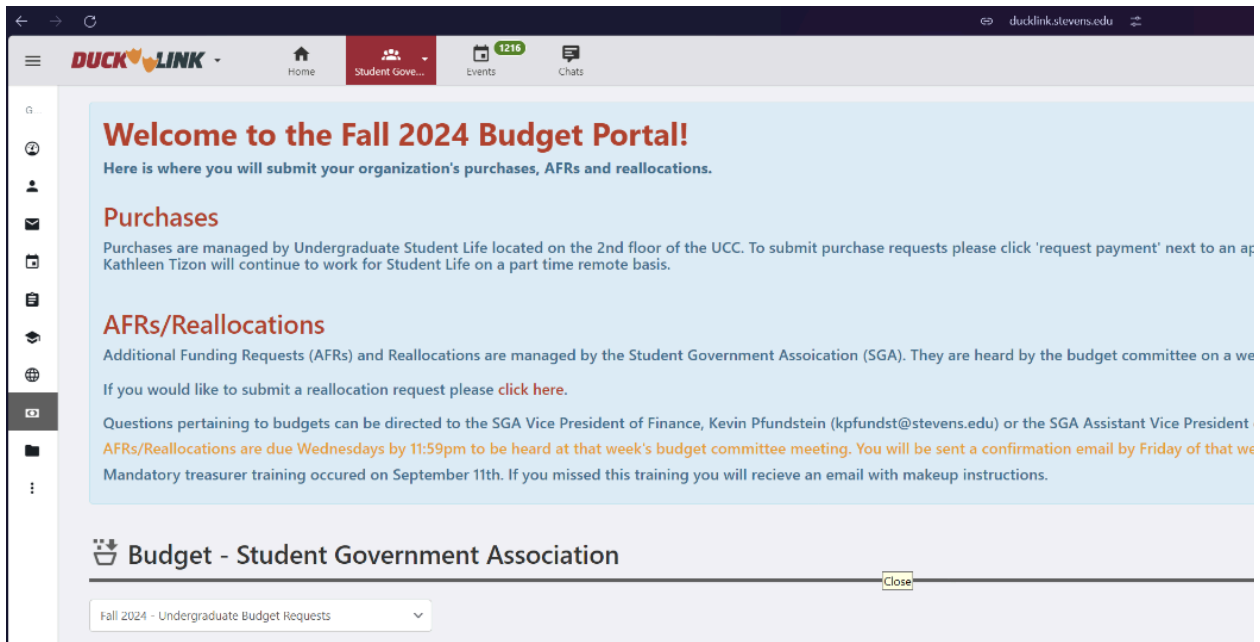
Step 1: Create your budget

That’s on you – just remember to itemize everything and add links to everything that you want to buy.

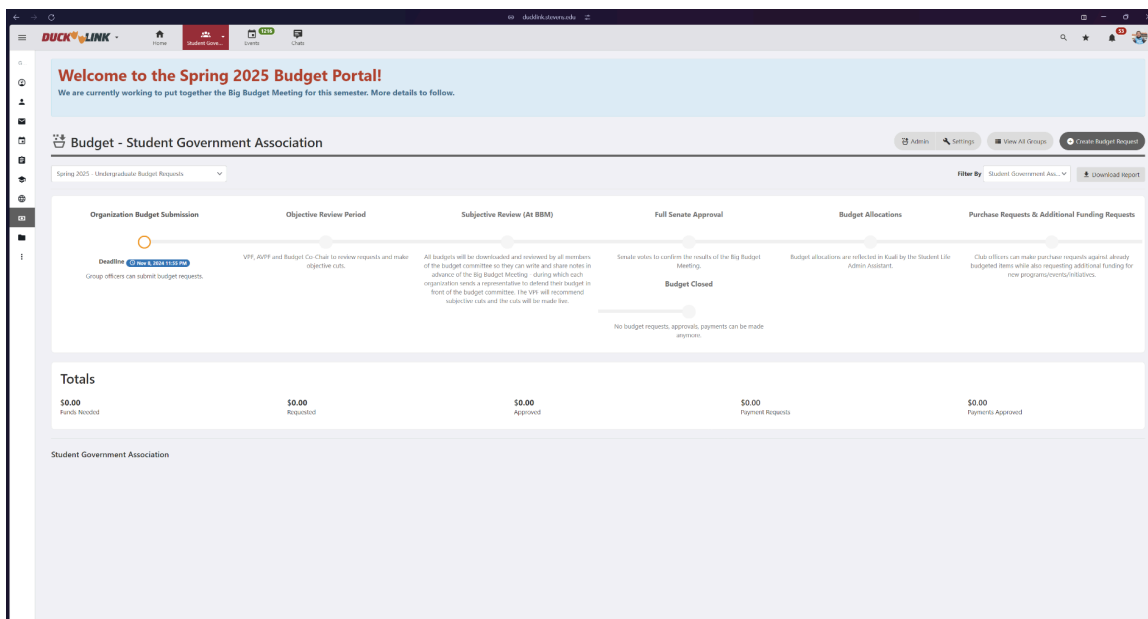
Step 2: Find Spring 2025 Budget



Click on the budget tab which in this picture is in the top left of the screen.



Right there under the “Budget - Student Government Association”(in your budget it will be your org’s name) click on “Fall 2024- Undergraduate Budget Requests,” and then click on “Spring 2025- Undergraduate Budget Requests.”



This is the page that you should find. Yours will have more text, the page is still under construction, but the key thing is that it says “Spring 2025 Budget Portal.”

Step 3: Use Create Budget Request Button

The screenshot shows the 'Budget - Student Government Association' page. At the top, a welcome message states: 'Welcome to the Spring 2025 Budget Portal! We are currently working to put together the Big Budget Meeting for this semester. More details to follow.' Below this, a navigation bar includes 'Admin', 'Settings', 'View All Groups', and a highlighted 'Create Budget Request' button. The main content area features a progress bar with six stages: 'Organization Budget Submission', 'Objective Review Period', 'Subjective Review (At BSM)', 'Full Senate Approval', 'Budget Allocations', and 'Purchase Requests & Additional Funding Requests'. The 'Organization Budget Submission' stage is currently active, showing a deadline of 'Nov 8, 2024 11:59 PM' and instructions for group officers to submit requests. Below the progress bar, a 'Totals' table shows \$0.00 for Funds Received, Requested, Approved, Payment Requests, and Payments Approved. The bottom of the page is labeled 'Student Government Association'.

The rightmost button which is in a gray color is the button that we will be using today. Click on that and you should get:

The form is titled 'Create/Edit a Budget Request (Step 1 / 2)'. It contains the following fields and sections:

- Budget Request Type:** A dropdown menu with '- Select -' as the current selection.
- Title:** A text input field.
- Description:** A larger text input field.
- Documents:** A section with an 'Upload' button.
- MORE DETAILS:** A section header followed by three input fields:
 - Event Location:** A text input field.
 - Event Start Date:** A text input field with a format hint 'Format: dd MMM yy'.
 - Expected Number of Attendees:** A text input field with a format hint 'Numbers only, no decimals'.
- Buttons:** 'Close' and 'Next' buttons at the bottom right.

Step 4: Fill out the form

Create/Edit a Budget Request (Step 1 / 2)

* Budget Request Type

Event

* Title

Cookies with the Cabinet

Description

An event with cookies, the cabinet, and prizes
<https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1FGgwUjJo-yS8p3sN2fOBUV-bWnNyBYU3vxq63cBDEjl/edit?usp=sharing>

Documents

Upload

MORE DETAILS

Event Location

Event Start Date

Format: dd MMM yy

Expected Number of Attendees

Numbers only, no decimals

Close

Next

This is what the first page of the form should look like once you have filled it out. If you are adding a link to a spreadsheet instead of uploading it, make sure that it is set so that everyone can access it.

Enter Budget Items (Step 2 / 2)

Item Type	Amount Requested	Amount Financed By Group	Total Funds Needed	Notes
Promotional Items	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	Notes
Total	0.00	0.00	0.00	

+ Add item

Back

Next

This is what the second page of the form will look like. Remember to use the “add item” to create different major categories. All food should be under one food item, all prizes under one prize item etc.

Item Type	Amount Requested	Amount Financed By Group	Total Funds Needed	Notes
Food and Drink	\$ 143	\$ 0	\$ 143.00	Notes
Prizes	\$ 135	\$ 0	\$ 135.00	Notes
Supplies	\$ 25	\$ 0	\$ 25.00	Notes
Total	303.00	0.00	303.00	

+ Add item

Back Next

This is what the second form looks like filled out for one singular event. Notice that each major category is its own item, even if I’m buying different food or prize items, they all go under their respective major category.

Step 5: BBM Form

Once you hit next after the “Enter Budget Items” Page. You should get this form:



 **BBM Form** DRAFT

 Edit  Copy Link  Manage

Big Budget Meeting Section Submission

Have you already scheduled your timeslot for the Big Budget Meeting and signed the acceptance statement? *

Did you follow all the guidelines described in the instructions at the top of the budgeting portal? Did you follow all the rules and regulations as described in Addendum E - Financial Policy? *

☐ Yes

☐ No

Please note you only have to answer "no" to this question once during your organization's BBM submission process.

☐ Yes

☐ No

The SGA Addendum E can be found here: <http://bit.ly/SGAFinancialPolicy>

Reminders

- Did you remember to include an shared google sheets link or upload a spreadsheet file on the first page of this section?
- Did you remember to limit itemization to one per category and instead itemize in a spreadsheet in order to facilitate easier purchase requests?

If you have any additional questions feel free to reach out to the Assistant Vice President of Finance, Arthur Serra (aserra1@stevens.edu)

Ensure you are CCing the Vice President of Finance, Kevin Pfundstein (kpfundst@stevens.edu) on all BBM communications!

☐ I'm ready for the Big Budget Meeting!!

Submit

It is pretty straightforward, however the first time you fill it out you need to click “No.”

BBM Form
DRAFT

Edit
Copy Link
Manage

Big Budget Meeting Section Submission

Have you already scheduled your timeslot for the Big Budget Meeting and signed the acceptance statement? *
 ☐ Yes
 ☒ No

Please note you only have to answer "no" to this question once during your organization's BBM submission process.

Every organization must have their BBM request heard in front of the budget committee and committee on student interests. In an effort to accommodate everyone's schedule we are allowing self-scheduling of time slot. You must pick a 5 minute time slot on either Saturday or Sunday the 16th or 17th of November. Changing or deleting another org's time scheduled time will result in a complete cut of your organization's budget

Please select your time slot by writing your organization's full name on the following spreadsheet:
https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1EGXnP9g8Wx-soLETLPJJDpZhaOFKykj58p_Ps3OG4/edit?usp=sharing

By signing below you agree that you or a representative for your organization who is familiar with the submitted budget will appear at the selected date and time before the budget committee. You understand failure to do so will result in denial of your organization's budget request.

Sign Here: *

Did you follow all the guidelines described in the instructions at the top of the budgeting portal?
 Did you follow all the rules and regulations as described in Addendum E - Financial Policy? *
 ☐ Yes
 ☐ No

The SGA Addendum E can be found here: <http://bit.ly/SGAFinancialPolicy>

Reminders

- Did you remember to include an shared google sheets link or upload a spreadsheet file on the first page of this section?
- Did you remember to limit itemization to one per category and instead itemize in a spreadsheet in order to facilitate easier purchase requests?

If you have any additional questions feel free to reach out to the Assistant Vice President of Finance, Arthur Serra
(aserra1@stevens.edu)

Ensure you are Ccing the Vice President of Finance, Kevin Pfundstein (kpfundst@stevens.edu) on all BBM communications!

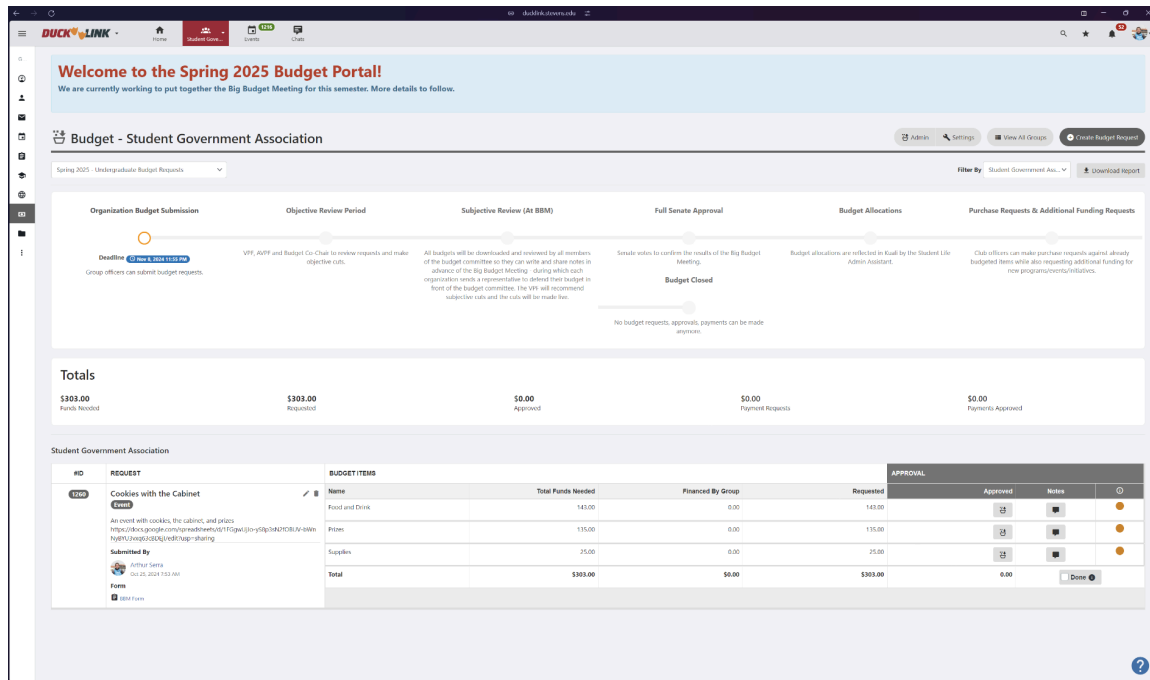
☐ I'm ready for the Big Budget Meeting!!

Submit

Follow the link to register for a time slot.

BBM Schedule									
File Edit View Insert Format Data Tools Extensions Help									
A3:33 100% 133 Arial 17 B I A									
If you are representing more than one organization, please take up one timeslot per organization									
1	Please enter your FULL ORGANIZATION name into the box next to your preferred timeslot.								
2	BBM is in []								
3	If you are representing more than one organization, please take up one timeslot per organization								
4	Changing another organization's timeslot will result in recommended reductions to your organization's budget.								
5	Note: Grey areas are buffer timeslots and cannot be used								
6	Saturday, November 16th								
7	Organization	Start Time	End Time	Organization	Start Time	End Time			
8		10:05 AM	10:10 AM		10:05 AM	10:10 AM			
9		10:10 AM	10:15 AM		10:10 AM	10:15 AM			
10		10:15 AM	10:20 AM		10:15 AM	10:20 AM			
11		10:20 AM	10:25 AM		10:20 AM	10:25 AM			
12		10:25 AM	10:30 AM		10:25 AM	10:30 AM			
13		10:30 AM	10:35 AM		10:30 AM	10:35 AM			
14		10:35 AM	10:40 AM		10:35 AM	10:40 AM			
15		10:40 AM	10:45 AM		10:40 AM	10:45 AM			
16		10:45 AM	10:50 AM		10:45 AM	10:50 AM			
17	Buffer	10:50 AM	10:55 AM	Buffer	10:50 AM	10:55 AM			
18		10:55 AM	11:00 AM		10:55 AM	11:00 AM			
19		11:00 AM	11:05 AM		11:00 AM	11:05 AM			
20		11:05 AM	11:10 AM		11:05 AM	11:10 AM			
21		11:10 AM	11:15 AM		11:10 AM	11:15 AM			
22		11:15 AM	11:20 AM		11:15 AM	11:20 AM			
23		11:20 AM	11:25 AM		11:20 AM	11:25 AM			
24		11:25 AM	11:30 AM		11:25 AM	11:30 AM			
25		11:30 AM	11:35 AM		11:30 AM	11:35 AM			
26		11:35 AM	11:40 AM		11:35 AM	11:40 AM			
27		11:40 AM	11:45 AM		11:40 AM	11:45 AM			
28	Buffer	11:45 AM	11:50 AM	Buffer	11:45 AM	11:50 AM			
29		11:50 AM	11:55 AM		11:50 AM	11:55 AM			
30		11:55 AM	12:00 PM		11:55 AM	12:00 PM			
31		12:00 PM	12:05 PM		12:00 PM	12:05 PM			
32		12:05 PM	12:10 PM		12:05 PM	12:10 PM			
33		12:10 PM	12:15 PM		12:10 PM	12:15 PM			
34		12:15 PM	12:20 PM		12:15 PM	12:20 PM			
35		12:20 PM	12:25 PM		12:20 PM	12:25 PM			
36		12:25 PM	12:30 PM		12:25 PM	12:30 PM			
37		12:30 PM	12:35 PM		12:30 PM	12:35 PM			
38		12:35 PM	12:40 PM		12:35 PM	12:40 PM			
39		12:40 PM	12:45 PM		12:40 PM	12:45 PM			
40		12:45 PM	12:50 PM		12:45 PM	12:50 PM			
41	Lunch Break	12:50 PM	12:55 PM	Lunch Break	12:50 PM	12:55 PM			
42		12:55 PM	1:00 PM		12:55 PM	1:00 PM			
43		1:00 PM	1:05 PM		1:00 PM	1:05 PM			
44		1:05 PM	1:10 PM		1:05 PM	1:10 PM			
45		1:10 PM	1:15 PM		1:10 PM	1:15 PM			
46		1:15 PM	1:20 PM		1:15 PM	1:20 PM			
47		1:20 PM	1:25 PM		1:20 PM	1:25 PM			
48		1:25 PM	1:30 PM		1:25 PM	1:30 PM			
49		1:30 PM	1:35 PM		1:30 PM	1:35 PM			
50		1:35 PM	1:40 PM		1:35 PM	1:40 PM			
51		1:40 PM	1:45 PM		1:40 PM	1:45 PM			
52		1:45 PM	1:50 PM		1:45 PM	1:50 PM			
53		1:50 PM	1:55 PM		1:50 PM	1:55 PM			
54	Buffer	1:55 PM	2:00 PM	Buffer	1:55 PM	2:00 PM			
55		2:00 PM	2:05 PM		2:00 PM	2:05 PM			
56		2:05 PM	2:10 PM		2:05 PM	2:10 PM			
57		2:10 PM	2:15 PM		2:10 PM	2:15 PM			

This is the spreadsheet that is linked to. Simply put your Organization's full name into a slot and that's it. **Removing or changing someone else's slot is grounds to have your entire budget denied.**



Once you hit submit on the BBM form, your budget should have a new line item!

Step 6: Repeat

Now just simply repeat until your budget is fully in!